SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 83

In Memory
of
Florence Fitch Patton

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas honors and commemorates the life of Florence Fitch Patton, who died January 7, 2026, at the age of 94; and

WHEREAS, Born on January 6, 1932, in Eagle Pass, Florence attended Saint Mary's Hall in San Antonio and pursued higher education at Sweet Briar College in Virginia and at The University of Texas at Austin, where she was a member of Pi Beta Phi and Pi Lambda Theta; in 1961, she and her husband, Branch, settled in Nacogdoches, which her family had called home since the 1830s; and

WHEREAS, Dedicated to education and historical preservation, Florence worked as an elementary teacher at Christ Episcopal School and as the founding principal of Fredonia Hill Baptist Academy; she wrote a treatise on free enterprise, which was used at teacher workshops statewide, and during her 24 years at the Sterne-Hoya House Museum, she developed interpretive materials that continue to inform public understanding of East Texas history; and

WHEREAS, Florence distinguished herself as state regent of the Texas Society Daughters of the American Revolution and also served on the leadership of the National Society Daughters of the American Revolution; she was a trustee for the Daughters of the American Revolution schools and the Nacogdoches Independent School District and held memberships on local historical and juvenile justice bodies; and

WHEREAS, Florence's historical and educational service was widely recognized; she earned the Stephen F. Austin State University Lumberjack Award for her coordination of a historical exhibit in 1984, and she was inducted into the Nacogdoches Heritage Hall of Fame in 2010 and received the Women in American History Award in 2023; and

WHEREAS, Throughout her life, Florence exemplified steadfast devotion to both faith and family; she served Christ Church in Nacogdoches as a vestry member, Sunday school teacher, and member of the altar guild for many years, and she found great joy in the love and companionship of her children, stepsons, grandchildren, and great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Florence Fitch Patton leaves a legacy of education, civic service, and devotion to community that will endure in the institutions she strengthened and the people whose lives she touched; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby extend sincere condolences to the bereaved family of Florence Fitch Patton; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for her family as an expression of deepest sympathy from the Texas Senate.

Nichols

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate